

NON-WSQ COURSE • C1382

Version v3.1 • 17 September 2026

Claude Cowork Masterclass

Live Artefacts, connected tools, skills and Projects — for finance teams

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome

- 1 Introductions
- 2 Ground rules
- 3 Course outline
- 4 How today runs

Let's Know Each Other

Take a minute to introduce yourself to the class.

1

Your name and role

Which team you sit in and what you are responsible for.

2

Your reporting work

One report or summary you produce again and again.

3

Your tools

Whether your finance data lives in Excel, Google Drive or a system.

4

Your goal today

What you would most like to stop doing by hand.

Ground Rules

Phones on silent

Step out quietly if you need to take a call.

Ask as you go

No question is too small — others usually have the same one.

Learn by doing

Every topic ends with a lab you build yourself.

Use the mock data

Never bring real client or personal data into a training exercise.

Check before you send

Approve every draft against the source figures.

Mutual respect

One conversation at a time; agree to disagree.

Course Outline

1

Claude Cowork Fundamentals

- The Claude product family
- Set up Cowork
- Live Artefacts
- Working with documents

2

Tools and Skills

- Connectors
- Drive and Gmail
- Agent Skills
- Do · Verify · Save

3

Claude Projects

- What a Project is
- Project instructions
- Assemble the workspace
- Lab 7: the Meridian project

Learning Outcomes

1

Process documents

Set up the Cowork desktop workspace and have Claude process a folder of documents into a structured summary.

2

Build a Live Artefact

Build, save and download a Live Artefact, including an interactive sales dashboard from supplied data.

3

Connect Drive

Connect the Google Drive connector so Claude can read finance data held outside the chat.

4

Deliver by Gmail

Refresh a Live Artefact from connected data and send an approved summary with the Gmail connector.

5

Save it as a skill

Turn a verified routine into an Agent Skill with /skill-creator, update it, and explain a skill's three layers.

6

Build the Project

Assemble a Claude Project that holds the data, instructions, skill and dashboard as one reusable team workspace.

Lesson Plan — One Day

9:00am – 6:00pm, with a one-hour lunch and two tea breaks.

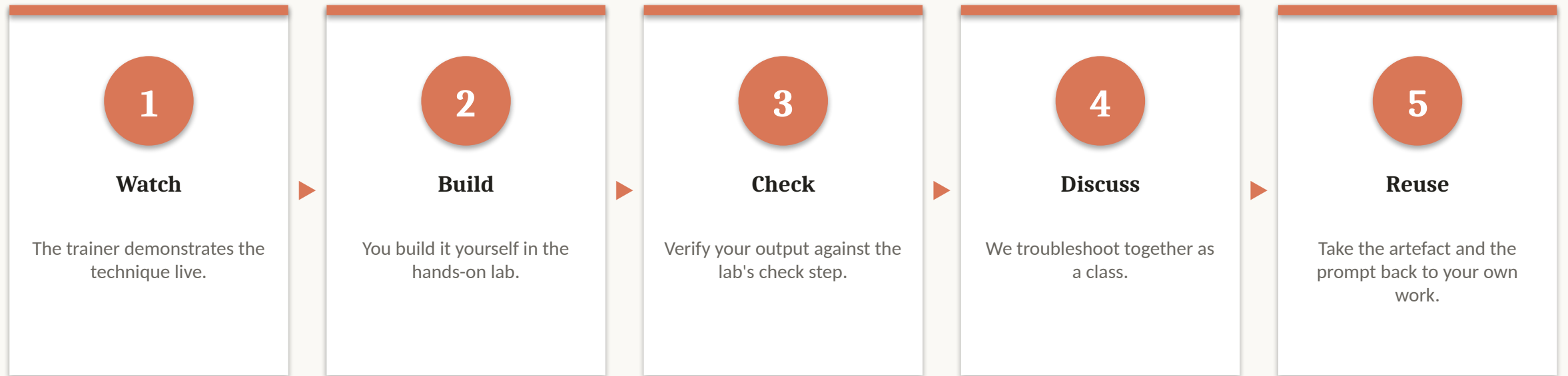
Morning

- 9:00 Welcome
- 9:20 Topic 1 — Claude Cowork Fundamentals
- 10:00 Topic 1 — Live Artefacts
- 10:30 Tea break
- 10:45 Topic 1 — Working with documents
- 11:15 Hands-on: Labs 1, 2

Afternoon

- 12:30 Lunch break
- 13:30 Hands-on: Lab 3
- 14:10 Topic 2 — Tools and Skills
- 14:40 Hands-on: Labs 4, 5
- 15:35 Tea break
- 15:50 Topic 2 — Agent Skills
- 16:10 Hands-on: Lab 6
- 16:45 Topic 3 — Claude Projects
- 17:05 Hands-on: Lab 7
- 17:45 Recap

How You'll Learn



Seven labs, one continuous scenario — each lab builds on the one before it.

THE SCENARIO

One firm, seven labs

Meridian Capital Partners is a fictitious Singapore-based investment and advisory firm with four revenue desks — Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit and Corporate Finance. All figures, clients, staff and documents in this course are synthetic and used for training only.

TOPIC 01

Claude Cowork Fundamentals

- 1 The Claude product family
- 2 Set up Cowork
- 3 Live Artefacts
- 4 Working with documents

The Claude Product Family

Anthropic offers several Claude products — here's how they differ so you know which is which.



Claude.ai

The chat assistant on web, desktop & mobile for everyday tasks.



Claude Code

Agentic coding tool in your terminal, IDE & desktop.



Claude Cowork

Desktop agent for non-developers to automate files & tasks.



Claude Design

Generates polished UI & frontend designs.



Claude for Microsoft

Claude inside Microsoft 365 & Outlook.



Claude for Chrome

Browser agent that navigates and acts on the web for you.

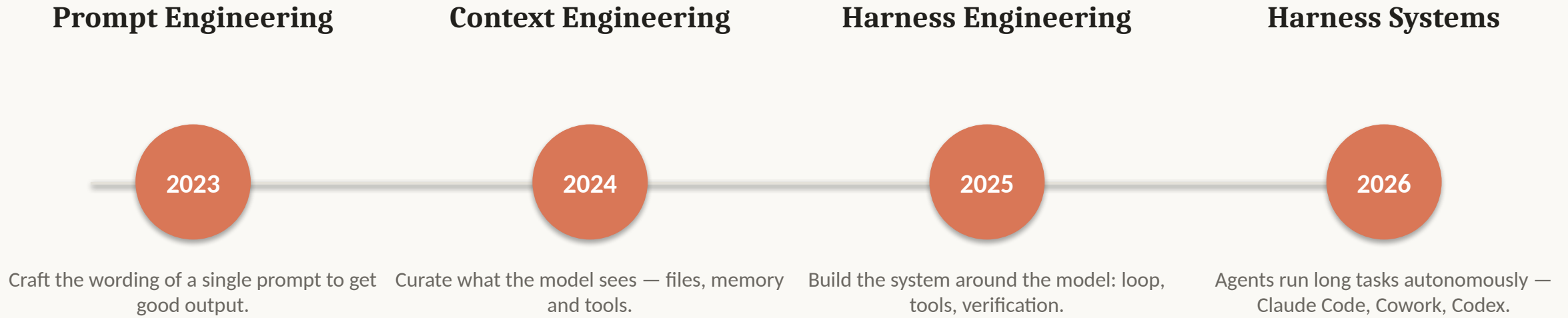


Claude for Science

Speeds up research workflows for scientists and labs.

TIP All are powered by the same Claude models — they differ in where they run and who they're for.

The Evolution of AI Engineering



More capable models shift the work from wording prompts → curating context → engineering the whole harness.

Set Up Claude Cowork

Cowork runs in the Claude desktop app on a paid plan.

1

Install the desktop app

Download Claude for Mac or Windows from claude.ai/download — Live Artefacts and local file access are desktop features.

2

Sign in on a paid plan

Cowork is available on paid plans; sign in with the account that has your subscription.

3

Open Cowork

Choose Cowork in the sidebar to get the agent workspace rather than a plain chat.

4

Point it at a folder

Connect the one folder for the task so Claude reads your files and writes its output back.

5

Enable what it needs

Turn on only the connectors the task needs, from the + menu.

6

Keep the app open

The desktop app must stay open while a task is using your computer.

Why a Live Artefact?

The difference between an answer you read and a tool you keep.

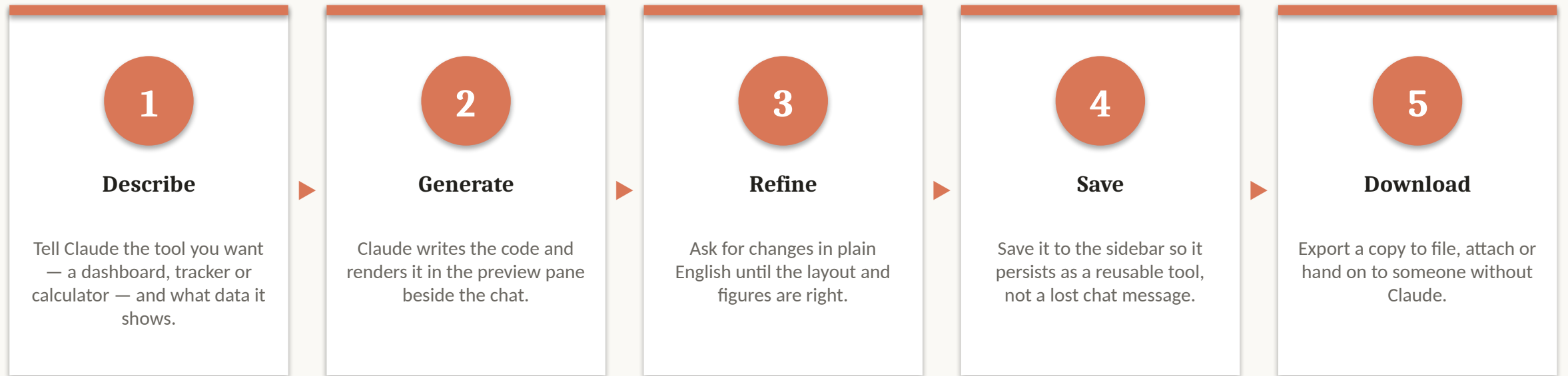
A normal chat answer

- A static snapshot in the conversation.
- Scrolls away as the chat grows.
- Figures are frozen at the moment they were written.
- You copy and paste to reuse anything.
- Nothing to click, filter or explore.

A Live Artefact

- An interactive tool with its own space in the sidebar.
- Reopenable — it stays available after the chat ends.
- Pulls fresh data when you open it.
- Keeps what you typed into it between sessions.
- Clickable: filter, sort and drill into the numbers.

Building a Live Artefact



You describe the outcome in plain English — Claude writes and runs the code.

Key Concepts — Claude Cowork Fundamentals

1

Claude Cowork

The desktop agent that works on your files and tasks — built for non-developers, not coders.

2

Live Artefacts

Interactive tools that persist in your workspace and refresh their data when reopened.

3

Desktop, not browser

Live Artefacts and local file access need the Claude desktop app on a paid plan.

4

Describe, don't code

You describe the tool you want in plain English; Claude writes and runs the code.

5

Save to the sidebar

A saved artefact is reopenable and reusable — it is not lost in the chat history.

6

Download to share

Export the artefact so it can be filed, attached or handed to someone without Claude.

Process a Folder of Invoices

LAB 01

Meridian's accountant needs the 2025 supplier invoices summarised and filed. You point Cowork at a folder of 126 PDFs — a full year of invoices, a few expense receipts, and the untidy filenames a real downloads folder collects — and have it read every document, build one CSV, and sort the files into month folders. This is work no dashboard can do: reading documents and acting on your file system. It is also far more than you would ever do by hand, which is the point.

YOU'LL BUILD

An `invoices_2025.csv` summary plus the PDFs filed into YEAR-MONTH folders.

Tools: Claude Cowork, local files, PDF reading

Extract the invoice data and file the PDFs

PROMPT — copy into Claude

In this folder are all my invoices from 2025. I need you to process these so I can send them to my accountant.

Read each invoice and extract the following data points:

- invoice number
- invoice sender
- invoice sender address
- invoice date
- invoice due date
- total amount due
- currency

NOTE Continues on the next slide.

Extract the invoice data and file the PDFs (cont.)

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Then create a CSV called invoices_2025.csv where you store all this information as well as the filename.

After you have extracted the information, move each invoice PDF into sub folders based on the YEAR-MONTH of the invoice date, using the naming convention 2025-01, 2025-02 and so on.

Flag anything that does not look like a normal supplier invoice, or that you think I should check. Do not delete any file.

NOTE Work on a copy of the folder — tell Claude to move files, never to delete them.

Process a Folder of Invoices

1

Open the Claude desktop app, sign in, and choose Cowork in the sidebar.

WHY THIS STEP

Cowork is a desktop feature on a paid plan — the browser version cannot reach your files.



Step 1 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

2

Copy the lab's "2025 Invoices" folder somewhere you can work on it.

WHY THIS STEP

Always run a file-moving task against a copy the first time, so a mistake costs nothing.



Step 2 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

3

Open the folder yourself and skim it before you start — 126 files.

WHY THIS STEP

Two have machine-generated names and one looks like a duplicate. You cannot check 126 documents by hand, but you can check that the summary adds up.



Step 3 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

4

Start a Cowork session pointed at that folder, then paste the lab prompt.

WHY THIS STEP

Cowork needs access to the folder itself, not an attachment, because it must move files as well as read them.



Step 4 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

5

Let Claude work through the PDFs — this one takes a few minutes.

WHY THIS STEP

It is reading each document, not guessing from the filename, which is why the oddly-named files still land correctly.



Step 5 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

6

Open invoices_2025.csv and check the row count against the folder.

WHY THIS STEP

Expect 121 invoice rows — 117 in SGD and 4 in USD — with the receipts and the duplicate flagged rather than silently mixed in.



Step 6 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

7

Total the SGD column and compare it against S\$777,954.81.

WHY THIS STEP

Spot-check a few rows against the PDFs too: a total that reconciles tells you the extraction held across all 126 files.



Step 7 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

8

Check the currency column — four invoices are in US dollars.

WHY THIS STEP

Never sum a mixed-currency column. This is exactly the kind of thing a human check is for.



Step 8 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

9

Confirm the PDFs now sit in 2025-01 ... 2025-12 folders and nothing was deleted.

WHY THIS STEP

The file dates come from inside each document, so a file named Jan can still be filed by its real invoice date.



Step 9 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

10

Read Claude's list of flagged items and decide what to do about each.

WHY THIS STEP

Claude surfaces the exceptions; you make the call — that is the working relationship this course is teaching.

Step 10 of 10

Process a Folder of Invoices

✓ Check your work

invoices_2025.csv lists every invoice with all seven fields plus the filename. The 117 SGD invoices total S\$777,954.81; the four USD invoices are marked USD rather than added to that total. The duplicated invoice and the four expense receipts are flagged rather than counted as ordinary invoices. The PDFs now sit in 2025-01 ... 2025-12 folders and all 126 files are still present.

Your First Live Artefact

LAB 02

Now you have seen Cowork do a real piece of work, meet the other thing it makes: a Live Artefact. You build a small tool rather than ask a question, so you can see how an artefact differs from a chat answer — it persists, it is interactive, and you can save and download it.

YOU'LL BUILD

A saved, downloaded Live Artefact — a working Meridian FX converter.

Tools: Claude desktop app, Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts

Build your first Live Artefact

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Build me a Live Artefact: a currency converter for Meridian Capital Partners.

Requirements:

- Convert between SGD, USD, EUR and GBP.
- Use these fixed demo rates from SGD: USD 0.74, EUR 0.68, GBP 0.58.
- One amount box, a from-currency and a to-currency selector, and a large result.
- Show the rate used underneath the result.
- Clean, professional finance styling. Label it "Meridian Capital Partners".

Make it interactive so I can change the amount and see the result update.

NOTE Rates are fixed demo values so the lab gives the same answer for everyone.

Your First Live Artefact

1

Start a new Cowork session — this lab needs no files.

WHY THIS STEP

Lab 1 gave Claude a folder to work in; here you are asking it to build something from nothing.

Step 1 of 6

Your First Live Artefact

2

Paste the lab prompt into the composer and send it.

WHY THIS STEP

Claude writes the code and renders the converter in the preview pane beside the chat.

Step 2 of 6

Your First Live Artefact

3

Try the converter: change the amount and switch the currencies.

WHY THIS STEP

This is what makes it an artefact rather than an answer — you can interact with it.

Your First Live Artefact

4

Ask for one refinement in plain English, for example: Add a thousands separator to the result.

WHY THIS STEP

Refining by conversation is the normal way to work — you never edit the code yourself.

Your First Live Artefact

5

Save the artefact so it appears in your sidebar.

WHY THIS STEP

A saved artefact persists as a reusable tool; an unsaved one scrolls away with the chat.

Your First Live Artefact

6

Download a copy of the artefact to your lab folder.

WHY THIS STEP

Downloading gives you a file you can keep, attach or hand to someone without Claude.

Your First Live Artefact

✓ Check your work

Converting S\$10,000 to USD shows US\$7,400. The artefact appears in your sidebar after saving, still works when you reopen it, and a downloaded copy is in your lab folder.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

LAB 03

Meridian's head of finance wants to see how the four revenue desks performed this year without opening a spreadsheet. You take the supplied sales data and build it into a Live Artefact dashboard — KPI tiles, a trend chart and a desk breakdown — then save it. This dashboard is the artefact every later lab builds on.

YOU'LL BUILD

A saved Live Artefact dashboard showing Meridian's FY2025 revenue by desk.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts, local files

Build the Meridian sales dashboard

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the attached meridian-sales-fy2025.csv, build me a Live Artefact:
an interactive sales dashboard for Meridian Capital Partners.

Include:

- KPI tiles: total revenue, total deals, average deal size, best desk.
- A monthly revenue trend chart for the full year.
- A breakdown of revenue by desk (Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit, Corporate Finance).
- A filter to show one desk at a time or all desks.

Format all money as Singapore dollars with thousands separators.

Use a clean, professional finance layout. Title it
"Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Revenue".

NOTE Attach the CSV from your lab's mock-data folder before sending the prompt.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

1

Open the lab folder and look at meridian-sales-fy2025.csv so you know what the data holds.

WHY THIS STEP

Always know your source before you ask Claude to summarise it — that is how you spot a wrong figure later.

Step 1 of 7

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

2

Start a Cowork session and attach the CSV, or point Claude at the lab folder.

WHY THIS STEP

Scope Claude to the one folder for this task rather than your whole drive.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

3

Paste the lab prompt and send it.

WHY THIS STEP

Claude reads the file, works out the totals and builds the dashboard in the preview pane.

Step 3 of 7

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

4

Check the KPI tiles against the CSV: total revenue should be S\$24,850,000 across 214 deals.

WHY THIS STEP

This is the verification habit — read the artefact's numbers back against the source.

Step 4 of 7

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

5

Use the desk filter to view Advisory on its own, then return to all desks.

WHY THIS STEP

Interactivity is the point of a Live Artefact: the reader explores instead of asking you for another cut.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

6

Refine the layout in plain English, for example: Move the KPI tiles above the chart.

WHY THIS STEP

Keep refining by conversation until the dashboard reads the way you want it to.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

7

Save the dashboard to your sidebar with a clear name, then download a copy.

WHY THIS STEP

You will refresh this same artefact from connected data in Lab 5.

The Meridian Sales Dashboard

✓ Check your work

The dashboard shows total revenue S\$24,850,000 and 214 deals, Advisory is the best desk at S\$8,420,000, the desk filter changes the chart, and the artefact reopens from your sidebar after you close it.

Recap — Claude Cowork Fundamentals

1

Lab 01

You can now extract structured data from a folder of PDFs and reorganise the files.

2

Lab 02

You can now set up the Cowork workspace and build, save and download a Live Artefact.

3

Lab 03

You can now turn supplied finance data into an interactive Live Artefact dashboard.

TOPIC 02

Tools and Skills

- 1 Connectors
- 2 Drive and Gmail
- 3 Agent Skills
- 4 Do · Verify · Save

What Connectors Do

Connectors let Claude reach data and services that live outside the chat.

1

Google Drive

Search and read Sheets, Docs, Slides and PDFs; upload files; create folders; save Claude's output back to Drive.

2

Gmail

Search and read mail, draft messages, send / reply / forward with approval, and manage labels.

3

Google Calendar

View events, find availability, and create or update meetings.

4

Approval by default

Claude asks for explicit approval before it sends, replies to or forwards an email.

5

Where to manage them

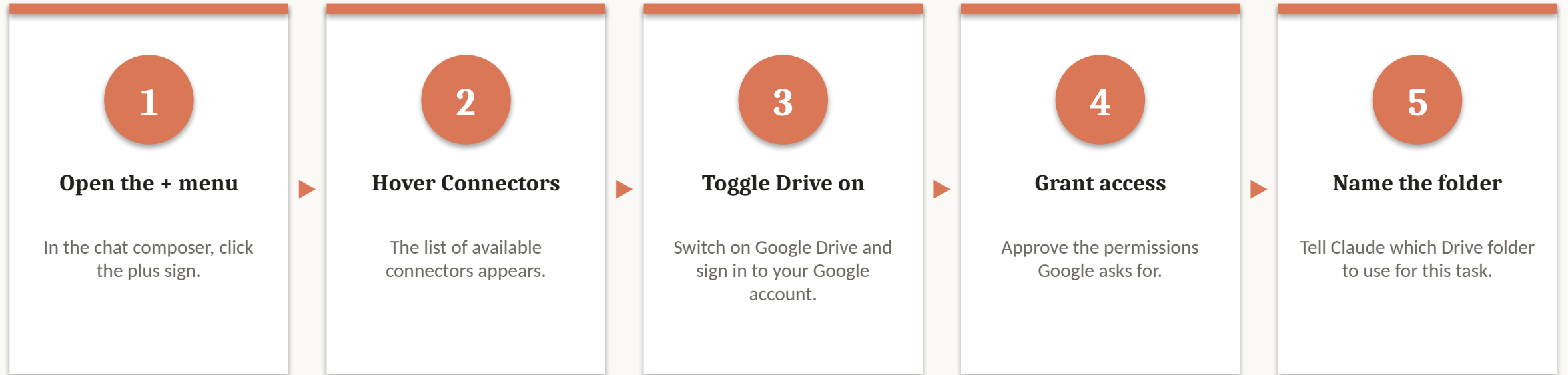
Individually from the + menu; account-wide under Customize → Connectors.

6

Known limits

Attachment contents are not read (metadata only) and images embedded in Docs are not processed.

Turning On a Connector



Manage them any time under Customize → Connectors.

Context Window

“

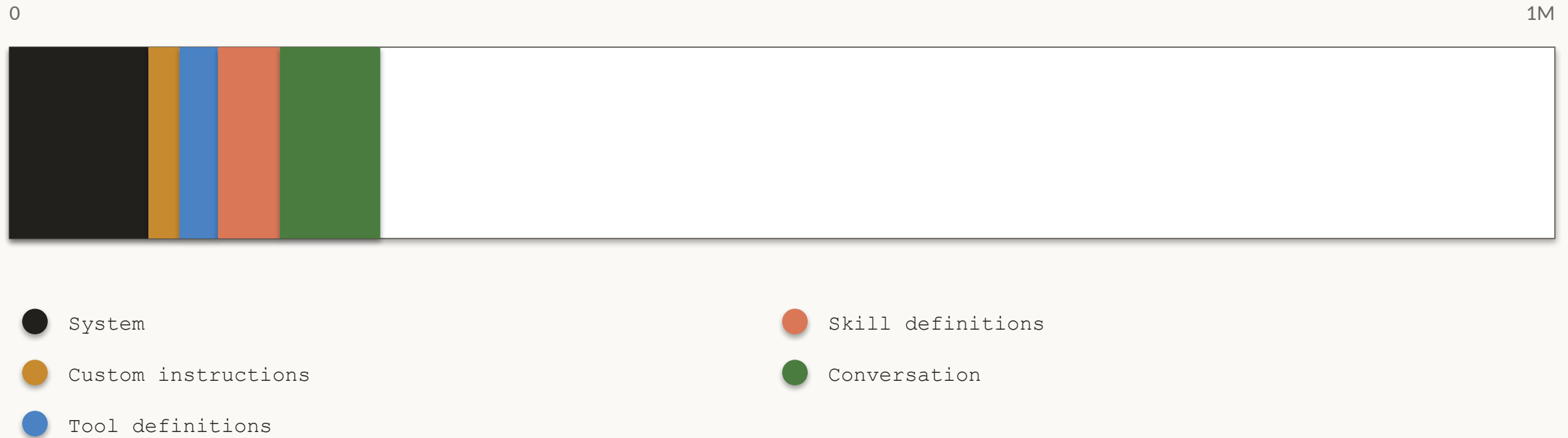
The context window is all the information the model can “see” when producing a response.

”

Files, instructions, tools and skills all have to fit inside it.

What Fills the Context Window

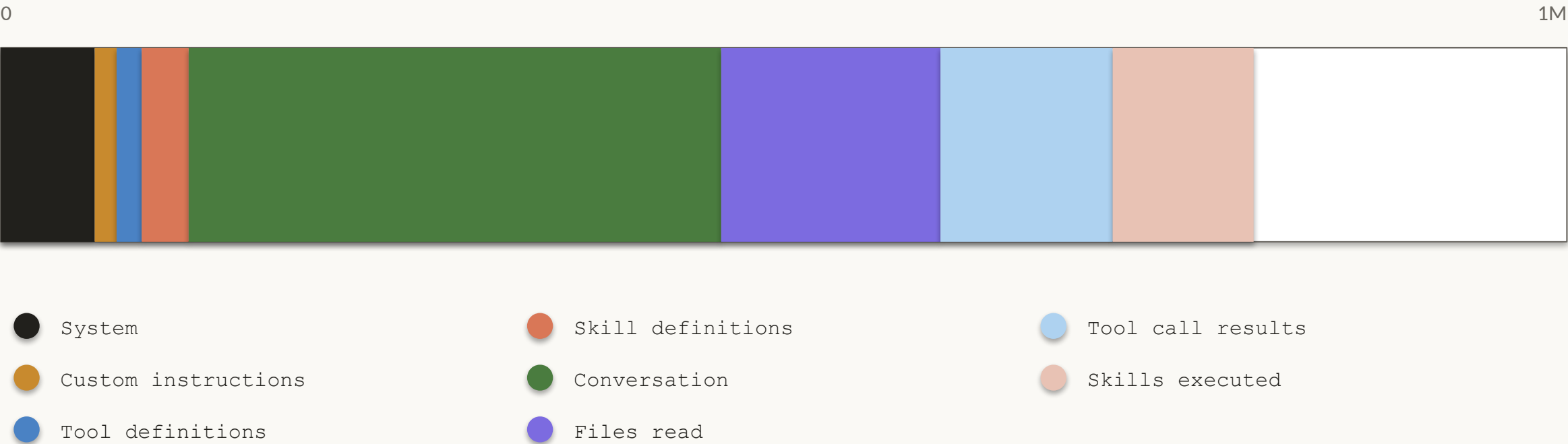
At the start of a session.



At the start of a session only the fixed overhead is loaded — most of the window is still free.

The Same Window, Later in the Session

After reading files, calling tools and running skills.



As the task runs, files, tool results and executed skills all accumulate. Start a fresh session for a new task rather than letting one fill up.

When the Context Window Fills Up

1. Context rot

Performance degrades. Recall of specific facts gets worse, the model starts confusing similar entities, and reasoning quality drops.

2. Tool confusion

Claude sees every tool definition. The more options competing for its attention, the more likely it picks the wrong one or fills in the wrong parameters.

3. Slower responses

The model processes every token on every turn. A bigger context means more work per message, which means longer waits before you see a reply.

4. Eats up your usage faster

Your entire context gets resent with each new message — so more tokens are burned per turn, and your limits are reached sooner.

The fix is housekeeping: one task per session, only the connectors you need, and only the files the task actually reads.

Five Levers of Context

What you actually control.

1

Conversation

Your prompt. The messages you send, including both text and attachments.

2

Working folder

The files and folders Claude can access while working on the task.

3

Connectors

The connected tools Claude can pull data from, and take actions in.

4

Skills

A set of instructions Claude follows for a repeatable workflow.

5

Instructions

Saved instructions at the folder level, which Claude always reads first.

Every lab today pulls one of these levers — the working folder in Lab 1, connectors in Labs 4–5, a skill in Lab 6, and project instructions in Lab 7.

Check It Yourself: /context

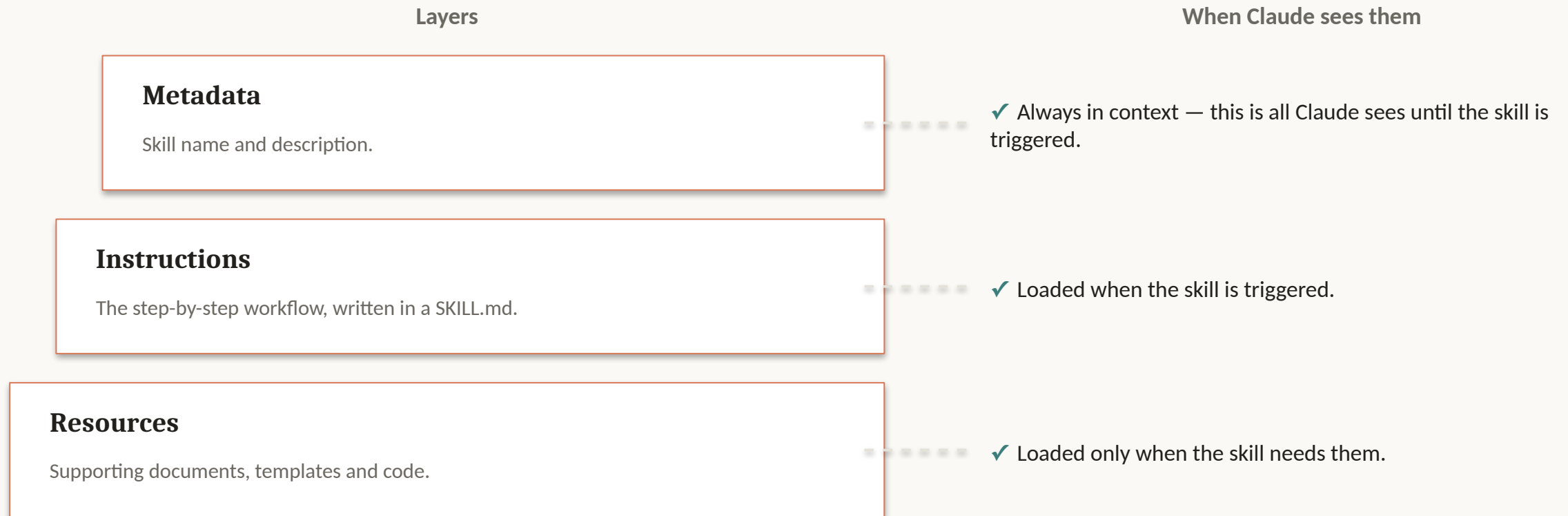
Estimated usage by category, for a 1M-token window.

Category	Tokens	Percentage
System prompt	35.3k	3.5%
System tools	768	0.1%
MCP tools	2.6k	0.3%
MCP tools (deferred)	301.7k	30.2%
Memory files	81	0.0%
Skills	9k	0.9%
Messages	13	0.0%
Free space	650.5k	65.0%

Run /context to see this for your own session. Note how much a large set of connectors costs before you have typed anything — turn off the ones you do not need.

Skills Are Documented on Three Layers

Each layer reaches Claude at a different moment — which is why the description matters most.



Anatomy of an Agent Skill

A skill is a folder Claude loads on demand when the task matches its description.

1

Metadata — name

A short identifier such as daily-brief. This is what you type to run it.

2

Metadata — description

What the skill does and WHEN to use it. Always in context, so this is what Claude matches against your request.

3

Instructions (SKILL.md)

The routine itself: which tools to check, in what order, and what to report.

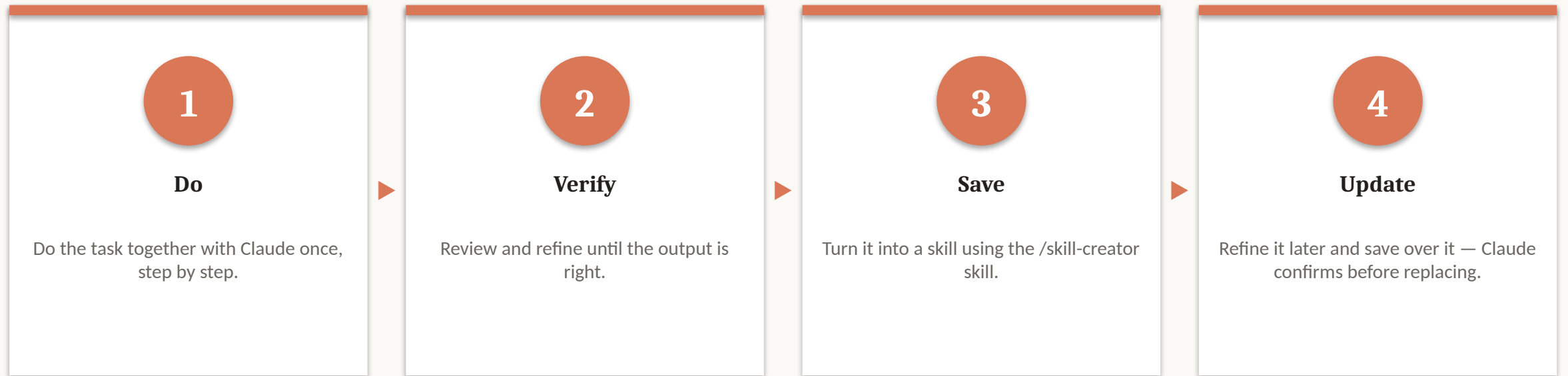
4

Resources

Optional templates, documents or code the instructions call on.

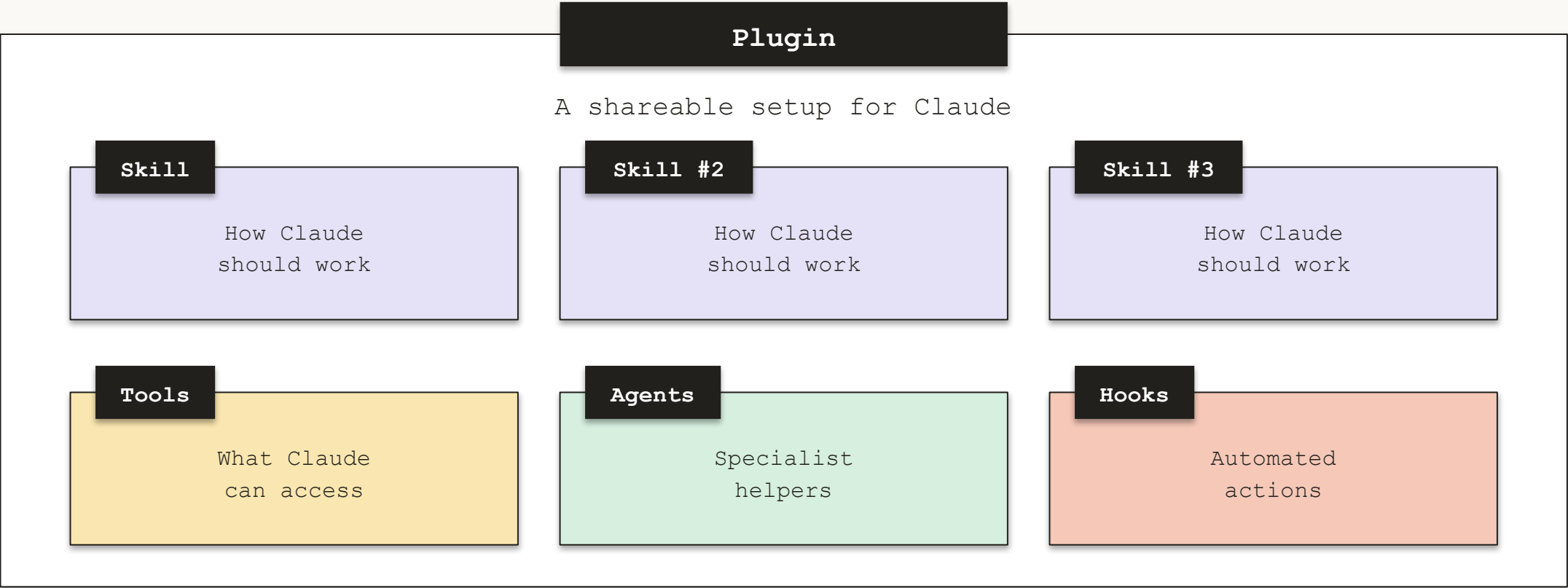
Creating Your Own Skill

Do not write a skill from a blank page — do the work first, then capture it.



`/skill-creator` writes the `SKILL.md` for you, from the run you just verified.

Skills vs. Plugins



A skill is one routine. A plugin is the whole setup — hand a colleague the plugin and they get every skill, tool and agent it contains.

A Skill vs Retyping the Request

Write the routine once, and run it by name from then on.

Retyping the request each time

- You describe the whole routine again every morning.
- Easy to forget a step when you are in a hurry.
- Each colleague words it slightly differently.
- The output format drifts from day to day.
- Nothing to hand to a new joiner.

An Agent Skill

- Written once in SKILL.md and run by name.
- Claude follows every step, every time.
- The whole team shares one folder.
- The same structure and format each run.
- Onboarding is: copy the skill folder.

A Skill That Drives Your Tools

The most useful skills combine the connectors into one repeatable command.

1

One command

Run the whole routine by name instead of describing it again each time.

2

Across your tools

The skill decides which connectors to check — Drive, Gmail, Calendar — and in what order.

3

A fixed structure

It reports back in the same sections every run, so you can scan it in seconds.

4

With fallbacks

When a source has nothing new, it says so plainly rather than inventing filler.

5

Still under approval

The skill drafts and reports; sending anything still needs your approval.

6

Shared with the team

Everyone runs the same routine and gets the same briefing format.

Key Concepts — Tools and Skills

1

Connectors

Toggle Gmail, Calendar and Drive on from the + menu so Claude can reach data outside the chat.

2

Google Drive

Claude reads Sheets, Docs, Slides and PDFs from Drive, and can upload files back to a folder.

3

Scope the folder

Point Claude at one Drive folder for the task — not your whole Drive.

4

Gmail

Claude drafts, sends, replies and labels — sending asks for explicit approval by default.

5

Agent Skills

A folder of instructions Claude loads on demand, so a task runs the same way every time.

6

Three layers

Metadata is always in context; the SKILL.md loads when triggered; resources load only when needed.

7

/skill-creator

Do the task once, verify the output, then let skill-creator write the SKILL.md for you.

8

Skills evolve

Update a skill as you learn what you want — saving over it replaces the old version, so re-run to confirm.

9

Skills use tools

A skill can drive the connectors for you — one command that checks Drive and Gmail and reports back.

Connect Google Drive

LAB 04

Meridian's finance data does not live on your laptop — it sits in a shared Google Drive folder. You upload the firm's wider finance files to Drive, enable the Google Drive connector, and confirm Claude can read them without you attaching anything by hand.

YOU'LL BUILD

A working Google Drive connection scoped to the Meridian finance folder.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Google Drive connector

Read the Meridian finance data from Drive

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Using the Google Drive connector, open the folder "Meridian Finance" in my Drive and tell me what you find.

For each file, give me:

- The file name and what kind of data it holds.
- The period it covers.
- The three figures you would use in a quarterly revenue summary.

Do not change, move or delete anything — read only.

List anything that looks inconsistent between the files.

NOTE Claude asks for approval before it moves, shares or deletes a Drive file.

Connect Google Drive

1

Upload the lab's mock-data files to a new Google Drive folder named Meridian Finance.

WHY THIS STEP

The lab supplies the quarterly workbook, the desk targets and the client list as mock data.

Step 1 of 7

Connect Google Drive

2

In Claude, click the plus sign in the composer and hover over Connectors.

WHY THIS STEP

This is where you turn individual connectors on and off for your account.

Connect Google Drive

3

Toggle Google Drive on and sign in to your Google account.

WHY THIS STEP

On a Team or Enterprise plan an owner must enable connectors for the organisation first.

Connect Google Drive

4

Approve the permissions Google asks for.

WHY THIS STEP

Approve only what you are willing to let Claude reach — you can revoke access later.

Connect Google Drive

5

Paste the lab prompt so Claude reads the Meridian Finance folder.

WHY THIS STEP

Naming the folder scopes the task; Claude does not need access to your whole Drive.

Connect Google Drive

6

Compare Claude's file summary against what you actually uploaded.

WHY THIS STEP

Confirm it found every file and read the right periods before you rely on it.

Connect Google Drive

7

Note any inconsistency Claude reports between the files.

WHY THIS STEP

The Q4 Advisory target deliberately disagrees between two files — a real check.

Connect Google Drive

✓ Check your work

Claude lists all three Meridian Finance files with their periods, reports FY2025 revenue of S\$24,850,000, and flags that the Q4 Advisory target disagrees between the two files — S\$2,320,000 in the targets file against S\$2,410,000 in the workbook. Nothing in Drive has been changed.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

LAB 05

Quarter end has arrived. You refresh the dashboard you built in Lab 3 using the data Claude now reads from Drive, then have it draft a quarterly summary email to the head of finance. You read the draft against the figures and approve it before a single message leaves your outbox.

YOU'LL BUILD

An updated dashboard plus an approved quarterly summary email sent to yourself.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Live Artefacts, Google Drive connector, Gmail connector

Refresh the dashboard, then draft the summary

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Two tasks, in order.

1. Open my saved "Meridian Capital Partners — FY2025 Revenue" dashboard and update it from the Meridian Finance folder in Google Drive. Add a Q4 column to the desk breakdown and show each desk's actual against its target.
2. Then draft an email to <YOUR OWN ADDRESS> with the subject "Meridian FY2025 — Q4 revenue summary". In the body:
 - Total FY2025 revenue and the Q4 figure.
 - Each desk's Q4 actual against target, best and worst first.
 - Two sentences explaining the largest variance.
 - A closing line noting the Q4 Advisory target discrepancy.

Show me the draft. Do not send it until I approve it.

NOTE Replace <YOUR OWN ADDRESS> with your own email — never a real client's.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

1

Reopen the dashboard you saved in Lab 3 from your sidebar.

WHY THIS STEP

You are extending the artefact you already built, not starting a new one.

Step 1 of 7

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

2

Enable the Gmail connector from the plus menu, alongside Google Drive.

WHY THIS STEP

Turn on only the connectors this task needs.

Step 2 of 7

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

3

Paste the lab prompt, replacing the placeholder with your own email address.

WHY THIS STEP

Class exercises always go to a test recipient — yourself.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

4

Watch Claude refresh the dashboard from Drive and add the Q4 target comparison.

WHY THIS STEP

The data comes from the connector now; you are not attaching files by hand.

Step 4 of 7

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

5

Check the refreshed dashboard: Q4 revenue should be S\$6,980,000 across the four desks.

WHY THIS STEP

Verify the artefact before you let it feed an email to your head of finance.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

6

Read the drafted email in full and compare every figure against the dashboard.

WHY THIS STEP

Claude asks for explicit approval before sending — this is the moment to use it.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

7

Approve the send, then confirm the message arrived in your own inbox.

WHY THIS STEP

Approve only once the figures match; if anything is wrong, ask for a correction first.

Refresh the Dashboard and Send the Summary

✓ Check your work

The dashboard shows a Q4 column with actual against target per desk and Q4 revenue of S\$6,980,000. The email arrives in your own inbox with the correct totals and a closing note about the Advisory target discrepancy.

Build a /daily-brief Skill

LAB 06

Labs 4 and 5 showed what the connectors can do — but you had to describe the whole routine each time. Now you capture it once. The reliable way to build a skill is the Do / Verify / Save pattern: do the task with Claude once, refine until the output is right, then use the /skill-creator skill to save it. You have already done the doing — this lab turns it into a command, then updates it.

YOU'LL BUILD

A daily-brief Agent Skill you can run by name each morning, updated once.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Agent Skills, /skill-creator, Google Drive connector, Gmail connector

Do the routine, then save it as a skill

PROMPT — copy into Claude

Step 1 — DO. Run my morning finance briefing for Meridian Capital Partners, once, so we can get the format right together:

- What changed in the Meridian Finance folder on Google Drive since yesterday?
- Which desks are behind their quarterly target right now?
- What finance emails do I need to respond to today?

If a section has nothing in it, say so plainly — "No new files since yesterday" — rather than padding it out. End with one line on what most needs my attention, or "Nothing urgent — have a good day" if there is nothing. All money in Singapore dollars. Draft only — never send email.

Step 2 — SAVE. Once I confirm the output is right, use the /skill-creator skill to turn exactly this routine into a skill called daily-brief that I can run every morning.

NOTE Do it once, check the output, then save it — that order is what makes the skill reliable.

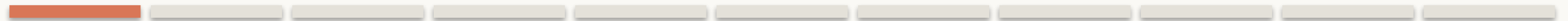
Build a /daily-brief Skill

1

Make sure the Drive and Gmail connectors from Labs 4 and 5 are still enabled.

WHY THIS STEP

The skill drives those connectors, so it can only work if they are on.



Step 1 of 11

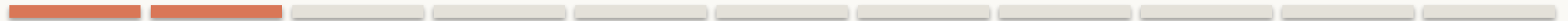
Build a /daily-brief Skill

2

DO — paste Step 1 of the lab prompt and let Claude run the routine once.

WHY THIS STEP

You are not writing instructions yet; you are doing the task together so Claude sees what good looks like.



Step 2 of 11

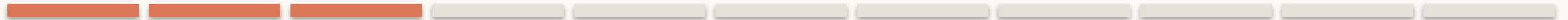
Build a /daily-brief Skill

3

VERIFY — read the briefing and ask for changes until the format is right.

WHY THIS STEP

Reorder a section, tighten the wording, fix a heading. Whatever you settle on here is what the skill will reproduce.



Step 3 of 11

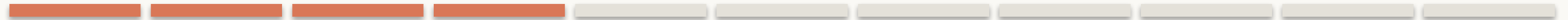
Build a /daily-brief Skill

4

Check the fallback wording on any empty section.

WHY THIS STEP

The fallbacks are what stop the routine inventing filler on a quiet morning — get them right before you save.



Step 4 of 11

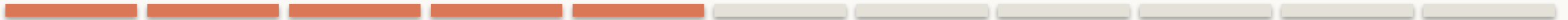
Build a /daily-brief Skill

5

Confirm it drafted and did not send anything.

WHY THIS STEP

A routine you will run unattended must not be able to send mail on its own.



Step 5 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

6

SAVE — run Step 2 so /skill-creator turns the routine into a daily-brief skill.

WHY THIS STEP

The skill-creator skill writes the SKILL.md for you, from the run you just verified.



Step 6 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

7

Read the SKILL.md it produces, especially the description line.

WHY THIS STEP

The description is how Claude decides whether to load the skill for a future task — make it specific.



Step 7 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

8

Run the skill by name, then run it again.

WHY THIS STEP

The same structure both times is the payoff: one command instead of re-describing the routine every morning.



Step 8 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

9

UPDATE — ask for one change, such as putting the emails section first.

WHY THIS STEP

A skill is not written once. You keep refining it as you learn what you actually want each morning.



Step 9 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

10

Save the change under the same skill name and confirm the replace prompt.

WHY THIS STEP

Claude warns that a skill with this name already exists and that replacing it cannot be undone — read that prompt before you accept it.



Step 10 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

11

Run the skill once more to confirm the change took effect.

WHY THIS STEP

Always re-run after an update; that is how you know the new version is the one being loaded.

Step 11 of 11

Build a /daily-brief Skill

✓ Check your work

Running the daily-brief skill by name produces a briefing with all three sections — Drive changes, desks behind target, emails needing a reply — using the plain fallback wording where a section is empty, ending with a single attention line, with all money in SGD and no email sent. After the update, the revised section order appears on the next run — and Claude warned you before replacing the existing skill.

Recap — Tools and Skills

1

Lab 04

You can now enable the Google Drive connector and read finance data held outside the chat.

2

Lab 05

You can now update the Live Artefact from connected data and deliver an approved summary by Gmail.

3

Lab 06

You can now turn a routine you have already done into a reusable Agent Skill, and update it.

TOPIC 03

Claude Projects

- 1 What a Project is
- 2 Project instructions
- 3 Assemble the workspace
- 4 Lab 7: the Meridian project

Why a Project?

A dedicated place for ongoing work, where context builds over time.

Working in one-off chats

- You re-attach the same files every session.
- Rules are restated from memory each time.
- Your artefacts are scattered across conversations.
- A colleague has to be told how you set it up.
- Knowledge leaves when you do.

Working in a Claude Project

- Files are added once as project knowledge.
- Custom instructions apply to every chat.
- Artefacts and skills live in one workspace.
- A colleague opens the project and is ready.
- The setup outlives any single conversation.

Three Ways to Start a Project

In Cowork, the files and instructions stay in a folder on your computer.

1

Start from scratch

Set up a new folder with instructions and files.

2

Import a project

Bring a project you made in Chat over to Cowork.

3

Use an existing folder

Give Claude a folder you already work from.

Creating a Project, Field by Field

New project → Start from scratch opens this dialog.

1

Name

What this body of work is called, e.g. Meridian Finance Reporting. Required.

2

Instructions

The standing rules for every chat in the project — house style, number formats, and the approval habit.

3

Add files

Drop in the files the work always needs, so no chat has to re-attach them.

4

Choose project location

Where the project folder lives on your computer — you can open and edit it outside Claude.

Then click Create. Memory can stay on, so the project also remembers what you work on over time.

What Goes in the Project

1

The project folder

A real folder on your computer holding the files and instructions — Claude works in it, and so can you.

2

Project instructions

The standing rules for this work: house style, SGD formatting, check before sending.

3

The finance data

The Meridian files, in the folder once, so no chat has to re-attach them.

4

Your skill

The daily-brief routine, available to everyone working in the project.

5

Your artefacts

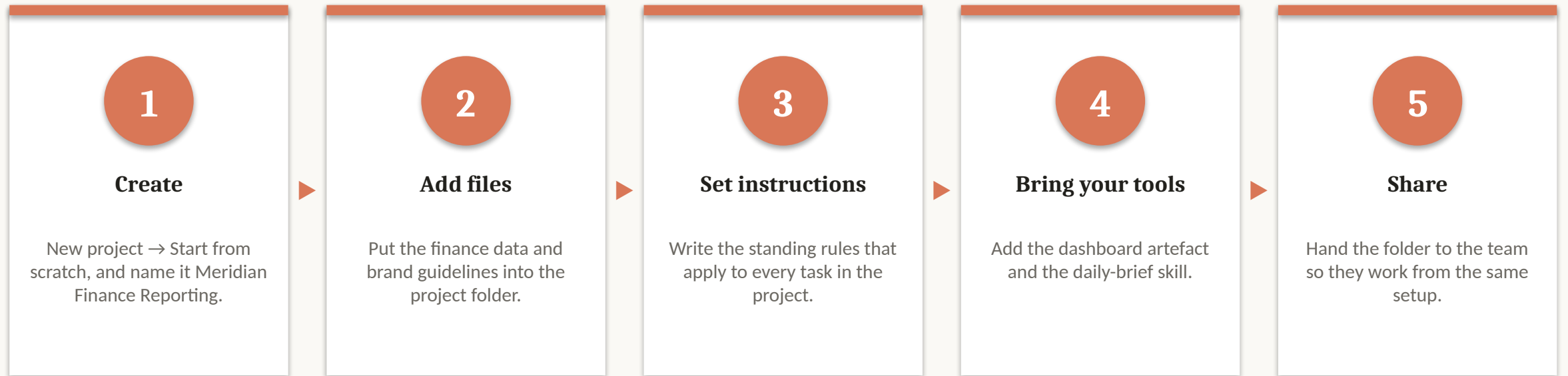
The FY2025 dashboard, saved where the team looks for it.

6

Connected tools

Drive and Gmail, already enabled for the tasks this project runs.

Assembling the Meridian Project



Everything from Labs 1–5, gathered into one workspace you can hand to the team.

Key Concepts — Claude Projects

1

A Claude Project

A dedicated place for ongoing work, where context builds over time instead of resetting each chat.

2

Backed by a folder

In Cowork the files and instructions live in a real folder on your computer — you can still open them yourself.

3

Three ways to start

Start from scratch, import a project you made in Chat, or point Claude at a folder you already work from.

4

Project instructions

Standing rules for this body of work — house style, SGD formatting, check before sending.

5

Everything in one place

The finance data, the brand rules, your daily-brief skill and the dashboard, together.

6

Share the folder

A colleague opens the same project and inherits the data, rules and tools you set up.

Build the Meridian Claude Project

LAB 07

Everything you have built so far lives in separate places — a dashboard in your sidebar, files in Drive, a skill, and rules you have been restating by hand. In this final lab you gather them into one Cowork Project: a dedicated folder on your computer where context builds over time, and which a colleague can open and be immediately productive in.

YOU'LL BUILD

A Meridian Finance Reporting project holding the data, instructions, skill and dashboard.

Tools: Claude Cowork, Projects, Agent Skills, Live Artefacts, Google Drive connector

Set up the project instructions

PROMPT — copy into Claude

This project is Meridian Finance Reporting. Write the project instructions that should apply to every task I run in here:

- We are the finance team at Meridian Capital Partners Pte Ltd. Our four revenue desks are Advisory, Asset Management, Private Credit and Corporate Finance.
- All money in Singapore dollars, thousands separators, no decimals.
- Variances show both the absolute figure and the percentage.
- Every report carries the title "Meridian Capital Partners" and the reporting period, and the footer "internal use only".
- Headings in a serif font, body text in a clean sans-serif.
- Tone: factual and concise. No marketing language.
- Always show me a draft before sending anything. Never send email without my explicit approval.
- The finance data in this project folder is the source of truth.

Write these as clear project instructions, then confirm what you will now do differently in every chat in this project.

NOTE Project instructions apply to every chat in the project — you stop restating them.

Build the Meridian Claude Project

1

In Cowork, choose New project, then Start from scratch.

WHY THIS STEP

The other two routes on that screen are Import a project (bring one over from Chat) and Use an existing folder (point Claude at a folder you already work from).



Step 1 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

2

In the Start a new project dialog, type the Name: Meridian Finance Reporting.

WHY THIS STEP

The dialog has four fields — Name, Instructions, Add files and Choose project location.



Step 2 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

3

Paste the lab prompt's rules into the Instructions box.

WHY THIS STEP

These are the standing rules — house style, SGD formatting and the approval habit — applied to every chat in the project.



Step 3 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

4

Under Add files, drop in the Meridian finance data and the brand guidelines.

WHY THIS STEP

Adding them once means no chat in this project has to re-attach them.



Step 4 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

5

Set Choose project location to where you want the folder to live, then click Create.

WHY THIS STEP

A Cowork project is backed by a real folder on your computer — you can open the files yourself at any time.



Step 5 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

6

Add the daily-brief skill from Lab 6 to the project.

WHY THIS STEP

The routine now travels with the project, so anyone working in it can run it.



Step 6 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

7

Open the project folder on your computer and confirm the files are really there.

WHY THIS STEP

This is what distinguishes a Cowork project — the instructions and files are a folder you own, not something locked inside the app.



Step 7 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

8

Save the FY2025 dashboard into the project so it sits with the data it reports on.

WHY THIS STEP

The artefact, its data and its rules finally live in one place.



Step 8 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

9

Start a fresh chat in the project and ask for a one-paragraph Q4 summary.

WHY THIS STEP

Test the payoff: no files attached, no rules restated, and the output already follows the house style.



Step 9 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

10

Confirm the folder holds the data, instructions, skill and dashboard, ready to share.

WHY THIS STEP

Handing a colleague this folder hands them the whole working setup.

Step 10 of 10

Build the Meridian Claude Project

✓ Check your work

A Meridian Finance Reporting project exists, backed by a folder containing the finance data and brand guidelines, with project instructions set, the daily-brief skill available and the dashboard saved. A brand-new chat in the project produces a Q4 summary in SGD with the correct header and footer without you attaching a file or restating a single rule.

Recap — Claude Projects

1

Lab 07

You can now assemble the data, instructions, skill and dashboard into one reusable Project.

WRAP-UP

Summary & Next Steps

- 1 What you built
- 2 Staying in control
- 3 Next steps
- 4 Q&A

What You Achieved

1

Process documents

Set up the Cowork desktop workspace and have Claude process a folder of documents into a structured summary.

2

Build a Live Artefact

Build, save and download a Live Artefact, including an interactive sales dashboard from supplied data.

3

Connect Drive

Connect the Google Drive connector so Claude can read finance data held outside the chat.

4

Deliver by Gmail

Refresh a Live Artefact from connected data and send an approved summary with the Gmail connector.

5

Save it as a skill

Turn a verified routine into an Agent Skill with /skill-creator, update it, and explain a skill's three layers.

6

Build the Project

Assemble a Claude Project that holds the data, instructions, skill and dashboard as one reusable team workspace.

Staying in Control

Claude drafts and builds; you check and approve.

Work from mock data

Use the supplied synthetic Meridian data — never real client records in training.

Scope the connector

Give Claude one folder for the task, not your entire Drive.

Check every figure

Read the artefact's numbers back against the source file before you trust them.

Approve before sending

Read the drafted email in full; approve it only when the figures match.

Use a test recipient

Send class exercises to yourself, never to a real client.

Keep the original

Let Claude write new files; leave the source data untouched.

Next Steps

1

Rebuild it with your own data

Repeat Lab 2 using a real report you own, on a copy of the file.

2

Connect one source

Enable the connector for the place your finance data actually lives.

3

Automate one routine

Pick the thing you do every morning and capture it as a skill.

4

Start one Project

Give your main body of work a project folder, and let the context build.

THANK YOU FOR ATTENDING

Your Cowork toolkit is ready

A Live Artefact dashboard, two connected tools, a daily-brief skill and the Project that holds them all.